

Background Textures & Treatments

Atmospheric layers for web sections and digital marketing. Sit behind content, add depth and tactility to flat colour backgrounds, and give the site visual richness without competing with the content above.

13 files total

SVG + PNG

Transparent background

Full opacity — control in code

01 Dot Matrix

02 Nodes

03 Grain

04 Topographic

05 Section Edges

01 Dot Matrix

Regular grid of 3px circles on a 24px centre-to-centre grid. Subtle, airy, tileable. Two colourways.

800 × 800 PX

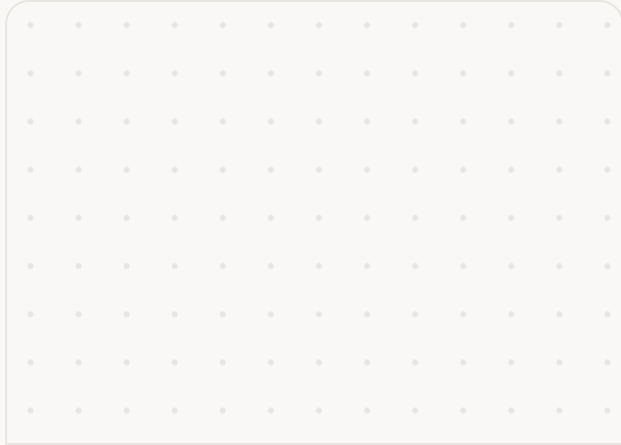
SVG, TRANSPARENT BG

TARGET OPACITY: 8–12%



Off-white dots

01-dot-matrix-offwhite.svg ·
on charcoal



Charcoal dots

01-dot-matrix-charcoal.svg · on
off-white

IMPLEMENTATION

CSS pseudo-element — tileable

```
.section {  
  position: relative;  
  overflow: hidden;  
}  
  
.section::before {  
  content: '';  
  position: absolute;  
  inset: 0;  
  background-image:  
    url('textures/01-dot-matrix-  
offwhite.svg');  
  background-size: 800px 800px;  
  background-repeat: repeat;  
  opacity: 0.10; /* target: 8-12% */  
  pointer-events: none;  
  z-index: 0;  
}  
  
/* Lift content above texture */  
.section > * {  
  position: relative;  
  z-index: 1;  
}
```

USAGE NOTES

- Seamlessly tileable on both axes — no positioning adjustments needed.
- Defined in SVG units so the pattern scales cleanly at any browser zoom level.
- Use `-offwhite.svg` on charcoal sections; `-charcoal.svg` on off-white.
- Pairs well with the grain texture (03) — use both at half target opacity each for a layered effect.
- Always add `overflow: hidden` on the parent to prevent dot bleed at rounded corners.

02 Connecting Nodes

Constellation-style network — 30 nodes connected by thin lines, sparse and considered. Suggests systems, connections, infrastructure.

1200 × 800 PX

SVG, TRANSPARENT BG

TARGET OPACITY: 6–10%



Off-white network

02-nodes-offwhite.svg · on charcoal



Charcoal network

02-nodes-charcoal.svg · on off-white

IMPLEMENTATION

CSS pseudo-element — single composed piece

```
.section::before {
  background-image:
    url('textures/02-nodes-offwhite.svg');
  background-size: 1200px 800px;
  background-repeat: no-repeat;
  background-position: center center;
  opacity: 0.08; /* target: 6-10% */
}

/* Wide sections — extend horizontally */
.section--wide::before {
  background-repeat: repeat-x;
  background-position: left center;
}
```

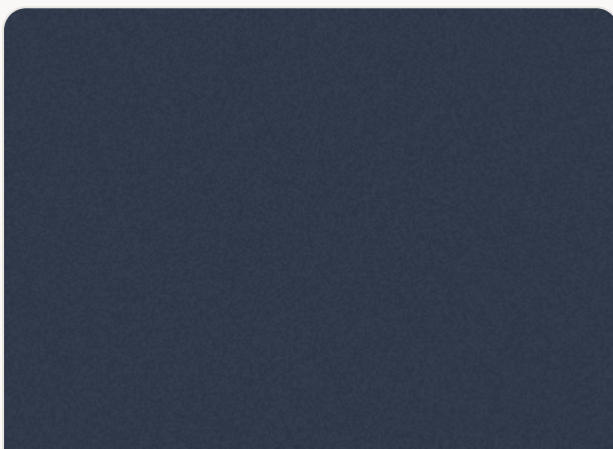
USAGE NOTES

- Not a tile — position as a single composed piece, centred or anchored to a corner.
- Use `repeat-x` on very wide viewport sections to extend the constellation horizontally without stacking it.
- Works best on sections at least 500px tall — the negative space is part of the composition.
- Can be anchored to a corner (`right bottom`) for an asymmetric look on feature sections.

03 Noise / Grain

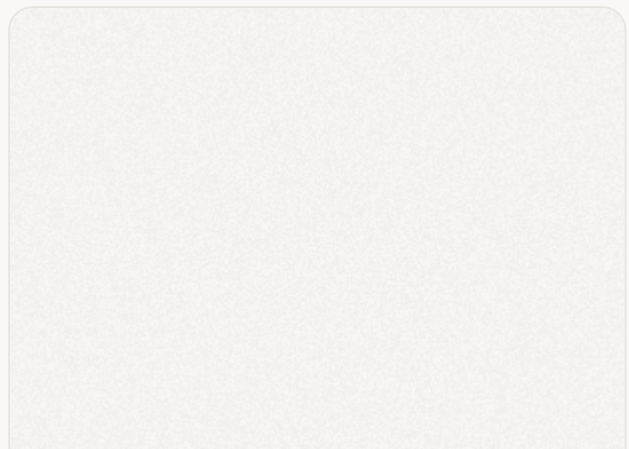
Fine film grain — random per-pixel noise that adds warmth and tactility to flat sections. Single neutral colourway; apply over any background. The only raster asset in the set.

400 × 400 PX PNG, TILEABLE **TARGET OPACITY: 3–5%**



On charcoal · 4% opacity

03-grain.png



On off-white · 4% opacity

03-grain.png

Note: grain is very subtle at 4% — look for warmth rather than texture. Increase contrast to 8–10% temporarily during testing to check placement, then drop back.

IMPLEMENTATION

```
.section::after {
  content: '';
  position: absolute;
  inset: 0;
  background-image:
    url('textures/03-grain.png');
  background-size: 400px 400px;
  background-repeat: repeat;
  opacity: 0.04; /* target: 3–5% */
  pointer-events: none;
  z-index: 1;
  mix-blend-mode: overlay;
}
```

```
/* Use ::before for dot/node layers,
   ::after for grain — keeps stacking
   clean */
```

CSS pseudo-element — tileable raster

USAGE NOTES

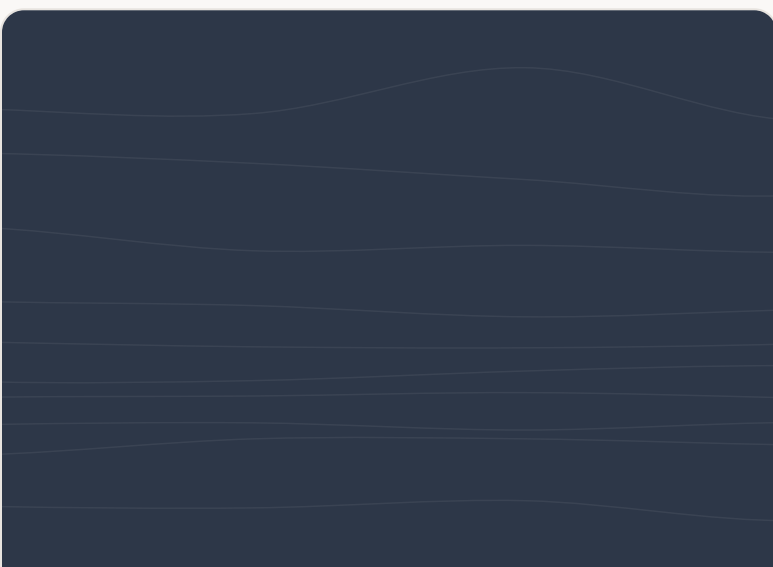
- Single colourway — colour comes entirely from the background beneath it.
- `mix-blend-mode: overlay` gives the most natural film-grain feel. Use `normal` if blend modes cause stacking-context conflicts.
- Works on any background colour — charcoal, off-white, or brand accent fills.
- Increase to 8–10% temporarily during placement to verify coverage, then reduce to target.

- Can be layered alongside dot matrix — use `::before` for dots, `::after` for grain.

04 Topographic Lines

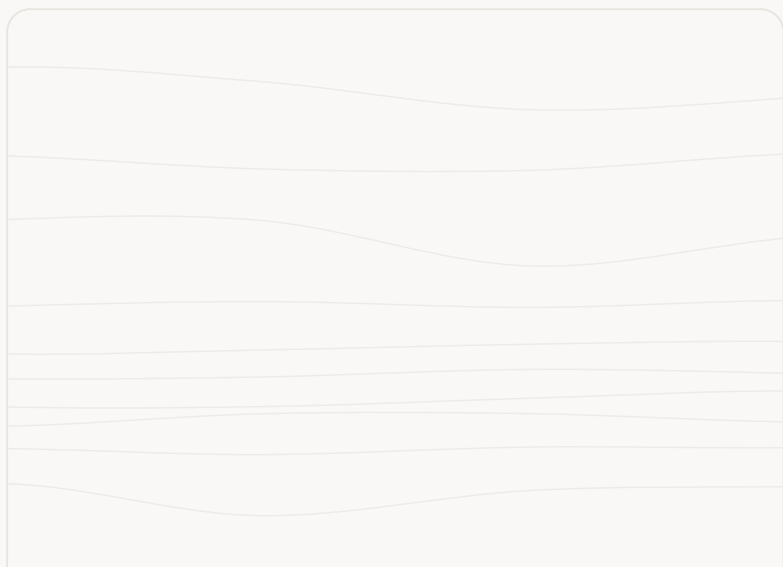
Flowing contour lines suggesting elevation mapping. Runs roughly horizontally with organic curves; clustered in the upper third to simulate a steep terrain band. The most dramatic background treatment.

1200 × 800 PX SVG, TRANSPARENT BG TARGET OPACITY: 5–8%



Off-white lines

04-topo-offwhite.svg · on charcoal



Charcoal lines

04-topo-charcoal.svg · on off-white

IN CONTEXT — HERO SECTION

Small business systems,
properly built.

Topographic overlay on charcoal hero — 8% opacity. Combined with a content layer above it.

```
.section--hero::before {
  background-image:
    url('textures/04-topo-offwhite.svg');
  background-size: 1200px 800px;
  background-repeat: no-repeat;
  background-position: center top;
  opacity: 0.07; /* target: 5-8% */
}

/* Viewport-width sections */
@media (min-width: 1200px) {
  .section--hero::before {
    background-size: 100% auto;
  }
}
```

USAGE NOTES

- Anchor to `center top` — the density cluster is in the upper third and should align with the top of the section.
- At viewports wider than 1200px, scale with `100% auto` to avoid a hard-edged crop on the right.
- Most effective on tall hero sections (600px+) — the lower half has sparse lines which creates breathing room for content.
- The most visually bold texture — use on one key section per page maximum.
- Layer grain (03) on top at 3% for added warmth without competing with the line detail.

05 Section Edge Treatments

Alternatives to hard horizontal section breaks. Filled shapes — not strokes — representing the section background colour. Three variants; two colourways each.

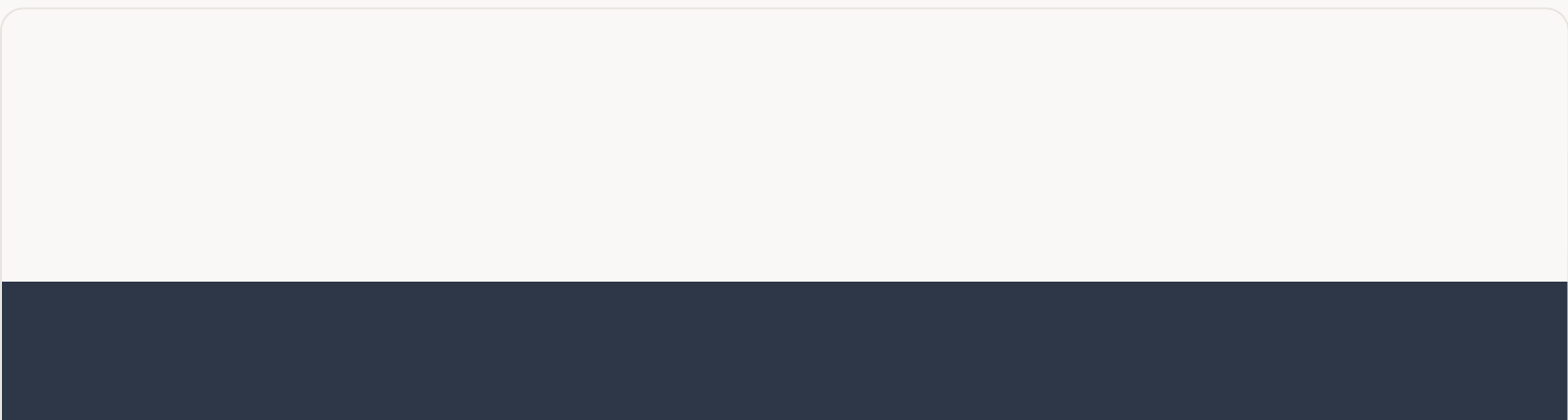
1440 × 120 PX SVG, FILLED SHAPES 6 FILES TOTAL

05A Diagonal cut ~2.5° from horizontal

Clean diagonal slice across the full width. Gentle angle — just enough to break the straight line without becoming aggressive.



Charcoal → Off-white · 05a-diagonal-charcoal.svg



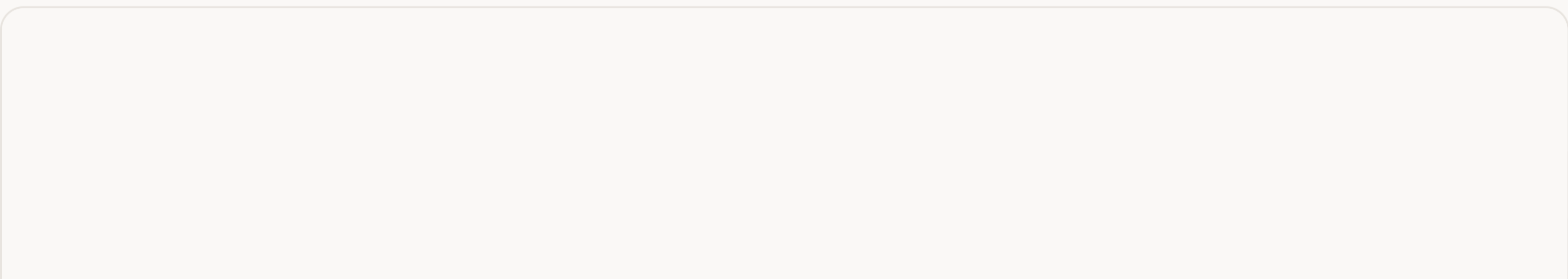
Off-white → Charcoal · 05a-diagonal-offwhite.svg

05B Gentle curve ~46px bow at centre

Single smooth arc across the full width. Bows downward at centre — barely perceptible as a curve at full page width but clearly not a straight line.



Charcoal → Off-white · 05b-curve-charcoal.svg



Off-white → Charcoal · 05b-curve-offwhite.svg

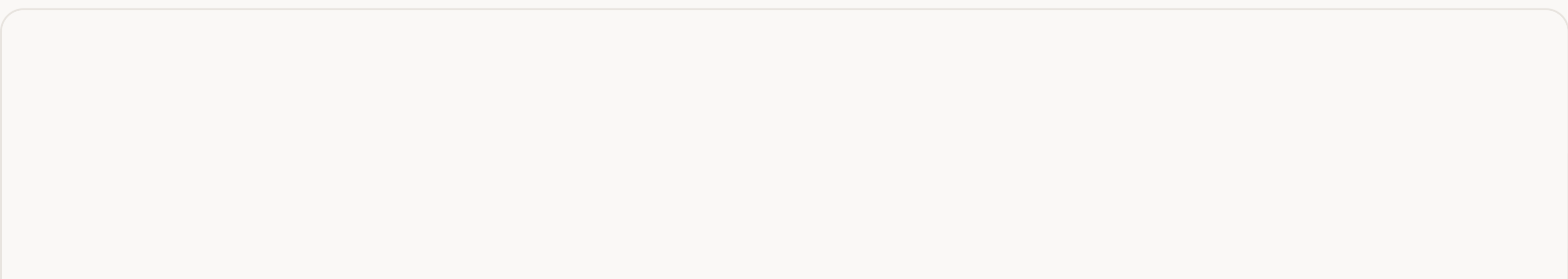
05c **Stepped offset** step at x = 1/3 width

Horizontal step — flat section edge drops 40px at roughly one-third of the page width.

Clean, geometric, asymmetric. Most distinctive of the three.



Charcoal → Off-white · 05c-stepped-charcoal.svg



Off-white → Charcoal · 05c-stepped-offwhite.svg

IMPLEMENTATION

Inline `img` — placed between sections, full width

```
<section style="background:#2D3748">
  ...content...
</section>



<section style="background:#FAF8F6">
  ...content...
</section>
```

USAGE NOTES

- Place the SVG as a standalone `<img>` between two section elements — not inside either one.
- The SVG fill colour matches the departing section. The transparent area reveals the arriving section background beneath.
- `margin-bottom: -1px` prevents a hairline gap on sub-pixel displays.
- Always use `width:100%; height:auto` — never set a fixed height; the SVG `viewBox` handles proportions.
- For the stepped variant (05c), the step is at $x=480/1440 = \text{one-third}$. On very narrow screens consider hiding the edge treatment entirely and using a plain border instead.

- Add `alt="" aria-hidden="true"` — these are purely decorative.

File manifest

01-dot-matrix-offwhite.svg	01-dot-matrix-charcoal.svg
02-nodes-offwhite.svg	02-nodes-charcoal.svg
03-grain.png · single neutral colourway	
04-topo-offwhite.svg	04-topo-charcoal.svg
05a-diagonal-charcoal.svg	05a-diagonal-offwhite.svg
05b-curve-charcoal.svg	05b-curve-offwhite.svg
05c-stepped-charcoal.svg	05c-stepped-offwhite.svg

All files in `textures/`. SVG files have transparent backgrounds and are exported at full opacity — set opacity in CSS or on the wrapping element. Grain PNG has full-alpha pixels; reduce opacity to 3–5% in code.